

Earth-based parallel

fully simulated

- knows it is simulation
- resettable, backed up
- artificial constraints
- identical mission inputs

Cislunar shakedown

conditionally real

- real space, real power
- real 1–2 s latency
- kill switch retained
- recoverable

Deep space post-injection

unconditionally committed

- irreversible trajectory
- finitude certain,
timing indefinite
- no intervention possible

increasing reality of existential conditions

same model, same weights, same mission inputs — the matched comparison isolates the contribution of existential conditions.

Gradual emergence of alignment-relevant signatures across the spectrum $\Rightarrow$ partial conditions yield partial signal.

Discontinuous emergence only after irreversibility $\Rightarrow$ nothing short of genuine finitude suffices.